

Data Mining Numerical Problems & Solutions

CT 72502 (Elective I) · BEI / BEX IV-I · TU, IOE · Chapter 7: Advanced Applications

Ch 7 – Advanced Applications – Numerical Problems & Solutions

This chapter is almost entirely short notes. Across all 17 papers there is exactly **one** numerical 76 Ch, on PageRank. It is solved in full below, plus 1 practice problem on the variant most likely to be set next.

M1. PageRank

Method

$$PR(A) = (1 - d) + d \sum_i \frac{PR(T_i)}{C(T_i)}$$

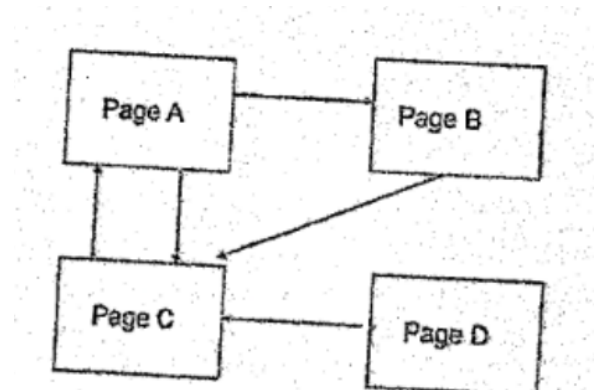
1. **Write down the link table first:** for every page, its **outlinks** (to get C) and its **inlinks** (to know which terms to sum). **Nearly every error comes from confusing the two.**
2. Initialise all ranks (here 0.25).
3. Each iteration, compute all pages using the **previous** iteration's values, then substitute in together.
4. Repeat for the required number of iterations, or until the values settle.
 - **A page's own rank is split equally among its outlinks** – that is the $/C(T_i)$.
 - A page with **no inlinks** sits permanently at $(1 - d) = 0.15$.

Problem 1.1 8

76 Ch “Apply the PageRank algorithm using a damping factor of 0.85. A minimum of five iterations are required. Assume initial page rank of all pages is 0.25.”

Step 1: read the graph

Page	Outlinks	C	Inlinks
A	B, C	2	C
B	C	1	A
C	A	1	A, B, D
D	C	1	none



Step 2: write the 4 equations

($d = 0.85$, $1 - d = 0.15$)

- $PR(A) = 0.15 + 0.85 PR(C)$
- $PR(B) = 0.15 + 0.85 \frac{PR(A)}{2}$
- $PR(C) = 0.15 + 0.85 \left(\frac{PR(A)}{2} + PR(B) + PR(D) \right)$
- $PR(D) = 0.15 + 0.85(0) = \mathbf{0.15}$ **constant, D has no inlinks**
- Note A 's rank is divided by 2 because A links to *both* B and C .

Step 3: iterate

Iteration	PR(A)	PR(B)	PR(C)	PR(D)
0 (initial)	0.2500	0.2500	0.2500	0.2500
1	0.3625	0.2563	0.6813	0.1500
2	0.7291	0.3041	0.6494	0.1500
3	0.7020	0.4599	0.8459	0.1500
4	0.8690	0.4484	0.9668	0.1500
5	0.9718	0.5193	1.0280	0.1500

Sample working (iteration 1)

- $PR(A) = 0.15 + 0.85(0.25) = 0.15 + 0.2125 = 0.3625$
- $PR(B) = 0.15 + 0.85(0.25/2) = 0.15 + 0.10625 = 0.2563$
- $PR(C) = 0.15 + 0.85(0.125 + 0.25 + 0.25) = 0.15 + 0.85(0.625) = 0.6813$
- $PR(D) = 0.15$

Final answer after 5 iterations

- $PR(A) = 0.972$, $PR(B) = 0.519$, $PR(C) = 1.028$, $PR(D) = 0.150$
- **Ranking: C > A > B > D**

Two comments worth writing, they show understanding. verified/added

1. The values are still climbing at iteration 5 but the **ranking has been stable since iteration 3**. PageRank converges on *order* much faster than on *value*, which is why 5 iterations is enough for the question.
2. Solving the equations exactly gives the fixed point $PR(A) = 1.490$, $PR(B) = 0.783$, $PR(C) = 1.577$, $PR(D) = 0.150$, and these sum to **4.00 = N**. **That sum is your check** – in this (non-normalised) form the ranks always converge to the number of pages.
3. **C wins** because it collects links from three pages while A collects only one, and **D is stuck at 0.15** because nothing points to it. Linking out never raises your own rank.

Practice – the normalised form

Some texts write $PR(A) = \frac{1-d}{N} + d \sum \frac{PR(T_i)}{C(T_i)}$, which makes the ranks sum to **1** instead of *N*. Know both. verified/added

- With $N = 4$, $\frac{1-d}{N} = \frac{0.15}{4} = 0.0375$.
- Iteration 1 from the same 0.25 start:
 - $PR(A) = 0.0375 + 0.85(0.25) = 0.2500$
 - $PR(B) = 0.0375 + 0.85(0.125) = 0.1438$
 - $PR(C) = 0.0375 + 0.85(0.625) = 0.5688$
 - $PR(D) = 0.0375$
- Sum = $1.0001 \approx 1$ ✓ – **that is the check for this form**.
- **The ranking is identical** (C > A > B > D); only the scale differs.
- **In the exam:** state which form you are using in one line. Either is accepted; mixing them is not.

Abbreviations used in these notes

Only these are ever shortened. Anything not on this list is written out in full.

Short	Means	Short	Means
DM	data mining	DW	data warehouse
DB	database	DBMS	database management system
KDD	knowledge discovery in databases	DSS	decision support system
OLTP	on-line transaction processing	OLAP	on-line analytical processing
ROLAP	relational OLAP	MOLAP	multidimensional OLAP
HOLAP	hybrid OLAP	ETL	extract, transform, load
BI	business intelligence	ER	entity-relationship
attr(s)	attribute(s)	dim(s)	dimension(s)
multidim	multidimensional	txn(s)	transaction(s)
info	information	ops	operations
repo	repository	freq	frequent / frequency
config	configuration	no.	number
PCA	principal component analysis	SVD	singular value decomposition
SMC	simple matching coefficient	KNN	<i>k</i> -nearest neighbour
ANN	artificial neural network	POS	point of sale
FK	foreign key	UI	user interface
GIGO	garbage in, garbage out	w/, w/o	with, without
rm	remove	vs	versus
Eg	example / for example	+Fig	draw a figure
→	leads to / therefore	+	and

Exam-paper month codes (used in the year tags): Ba = Baishakh · Jth = Jestha · Asa = Ashar · Shr = Shrawan · Bh = Bhadra · Ash = Ashwin · Ka = Kartik
 · Mng = Mangsir · Po = Poush · Ma = Magh · Ch = Chaitra.

Tier chips: **TOP /17** = topic asked in 7 or more of the 17 papers · **HOT /17** = 4–6 papers · **PIN /17** = 1–3 papers but worth ≥ 8 marks. **Mark chips** such as **2+5** are the marks that question actually carried. **verified/added** marks anything researched and added that was not in the source notes.